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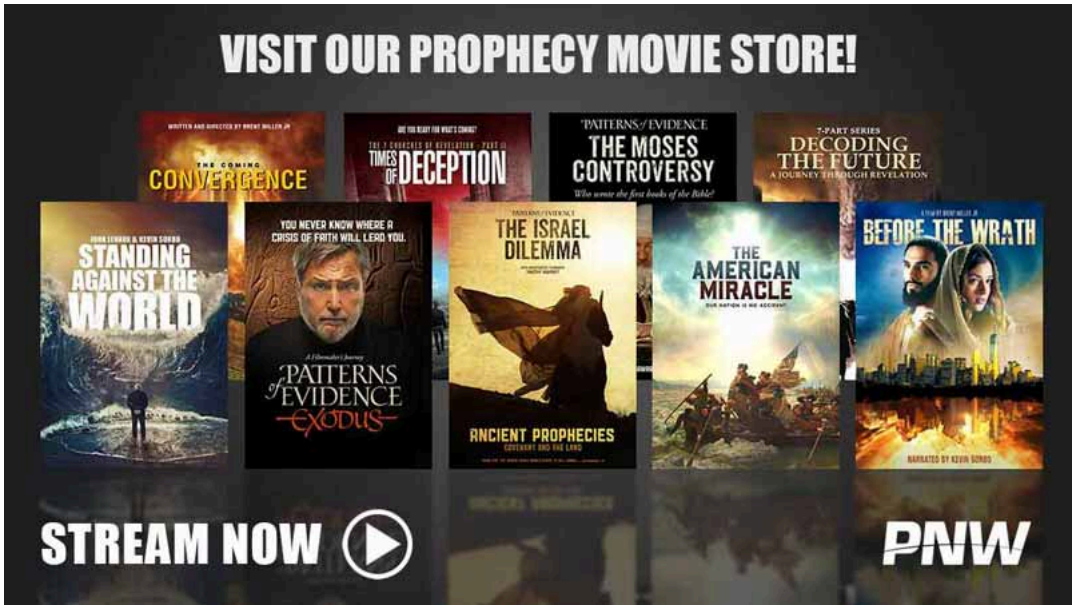


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ARTICLE

# The Christian Cohabitation Crisis Is Real

Boil a banana peel
It might sound strange, but it's something you should try!
Good To Know This

BY PNW STAFF APRIL 02, 2026

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A Texas church recently took a bold stand against one of the church's quietly growing compromises: cohabitation among Christian couples.

Not with another vague sermon about "relationships."

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Not with another watered-down message about "finding your person."
Not with another Christian influencer reel telling young believers to "just pray about it."

This time, a pastor stood up, told the truth plainly, and 52 couples responded in a public ceremony with something our culture almost never celebrates anymore: repentance, obedience, and covenant.

While the focus is often on Gen Z -- because they are just starting out in life and navigating relationships in a culture that normalizes cohabitation -- this is not solely a Gen Z problem. Christians of all ages struggle with delaying covenant, rationalizing compromise, and confusing convenience with God's design.

It is important to note these couples did not rush from conviction to ceremony without pastoral guidance. Lakepointe Church leaders made it clear that the church was ready to counsel and walk alongside each couple, helping them discern whether they were truly ready for marriage. While many couples acted quickly, others who initially expressed interest were advised to take more time, deepen their pastoral support, or reconsider before committing. This approach reflects a healthy church that prioritizes true covenant readiness over impulsive vows.

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**This Did Not Happen in a Vacuum**

The viral moment began with the testimony of Colton and Kaylee, a young couple who admitted they had been "Christians in name but not in how they lived." During premarital counseling, they were confronted with a simple truth: either honor God and get married, or stop living together. That confrontation cut through the haze of compromise. They chose obedience. They got baptized -- and then, just an hour later, got married. That testimony sparked dozens of others living in the same gray zone.

Conviction, when not softened into therapy-speak, forces a choice. And someone finally said the quiet part out loud in church.

Many young Christians drift into compromise, not because they reject marriage, but because no one ever clearly challenges them. Shared rent. Shared bed. Shared bills. Shared pets. Shared future plans. Everything but covenant.

Previous polls indicate that a significant number of evangelicals already view cohabitation as acceptable under certain circumstances. For example, a majority of white evangelicals have indicated that living together is acceptable if a couple plans to marry. Among younger believers, views become noticeably less aligned with biblical teaching: many in their 20s report cohabitation is acceptable even without plans to marry, and nearly half of evangelical Protestants aged 15–22 who are not currently married or cohabiting say they would probably or definitely cohabit in the future.

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**Who Is Josh Howerton -- and Why Are People Listening?**

Howerton has built a large online footprint through short, viral sermon clips, cultural commentary, and direct answers to controversial questions. His style is not sleepy, polished church-speak. It is confrontational enough to get attention, but accessible enough to travel online. He asks hard questions, names cultural idols, and speaks in a format Gen Z and Millennials actually consume. Lakepointe Church describes him as "a trusted and compelling voice on the cultural issues of our day."

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Cohabitation is no longer just a secular issue -- it's the church's quietly tolerated compromise. Young Christians often have excuses ready:

"We're basically married in God's eyes." No -- marriage is a public, binding covenant.
"We're saving money." Practicality is no exemption for sin.
"We're trying it out first." Covenant was never test-driven like a used car.
"We're already engaged." A ring is not a vow.
"We're serious / we'll marry eventually / it's not that big a deal."

The last is most revealing: the church has lowered the standard so much that delayed obedience seems acceptable.

**What Marriage Actually Means**

When the Pharisees questioned Jesus about marriage, He took them back to creation:

"But from the beginning of creation, 'God made them male and female' ... 'the two shall become one flesh.'"

Marriage is not social convenience. It is holy covenant, reflecting the relationship between Christ and His Church. Cheapening or delaying it distorts God's design.

**Why This Matters Beyond One Church**

Stable, intact families are still among the strongest predictors of flourishing: lower poverty, lower instability, and lower social dysfunction. Weak marriage = fragile communities. What happened at Lakepointe is bigger than a viral story: it shows revival is sometimes quiet, messy, and deeply practical. It looks like couples deciding to stop making excuses and churches refusing to normalize sin.

This is love with a backbone, not cruelty.

**The Challenge to Christians**

If believers want to rebuild trust, family, faith, and stability, it begins in homes -- and with young and older Christians alike stopping borrowed relationship habits while still asking for God's blessing.

The question is not whether 52 couples married, but whether thousands more are still sitting in churches, sharing beds, and telling themselves obedience can wait. It can't.

Deep down, those couples knew: delayed obedience is still disobedience.

Grace still welcomes the repentant. The church should cheer those who step forward. Pastors must not fear preaching clearly.

If more churches recover the courage to speak truth about cohabitation -- and then provide pathways toward repentance, counsel, and covenant -- they might discover what Lakepointe did: people are still willing to obey God. They may just need someone brave enough to ask them to.

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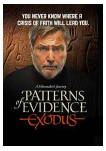


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